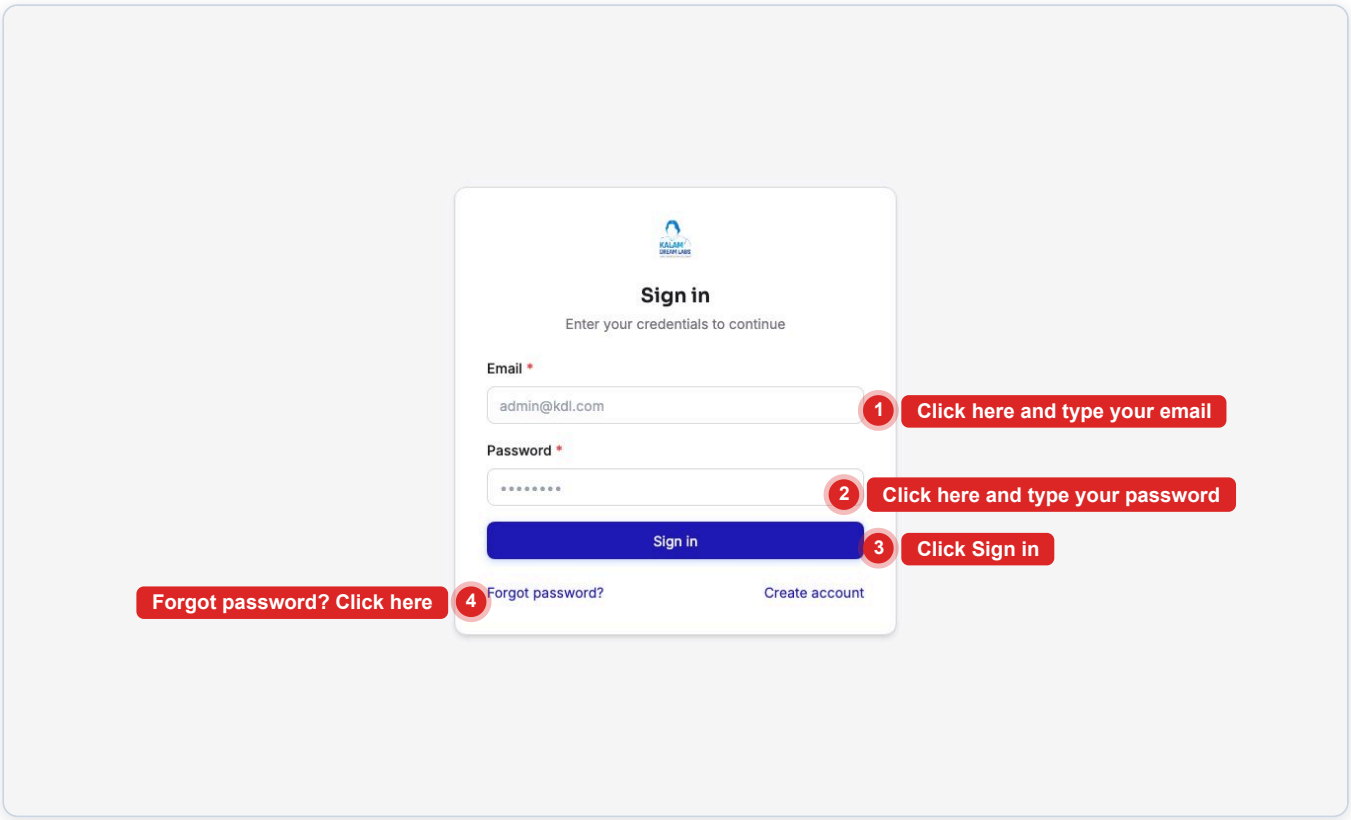
Step 1. Sign in

> KDL OS must already be installed and running. If not, follow the **Installation** guide first (Admin > Documents > Installation).

Open **http://localhost/login**. Email `admin@kdl.com`, password `kdl-dev-seed-password`. KDL OS asks you to choose a new password on first sign-in.

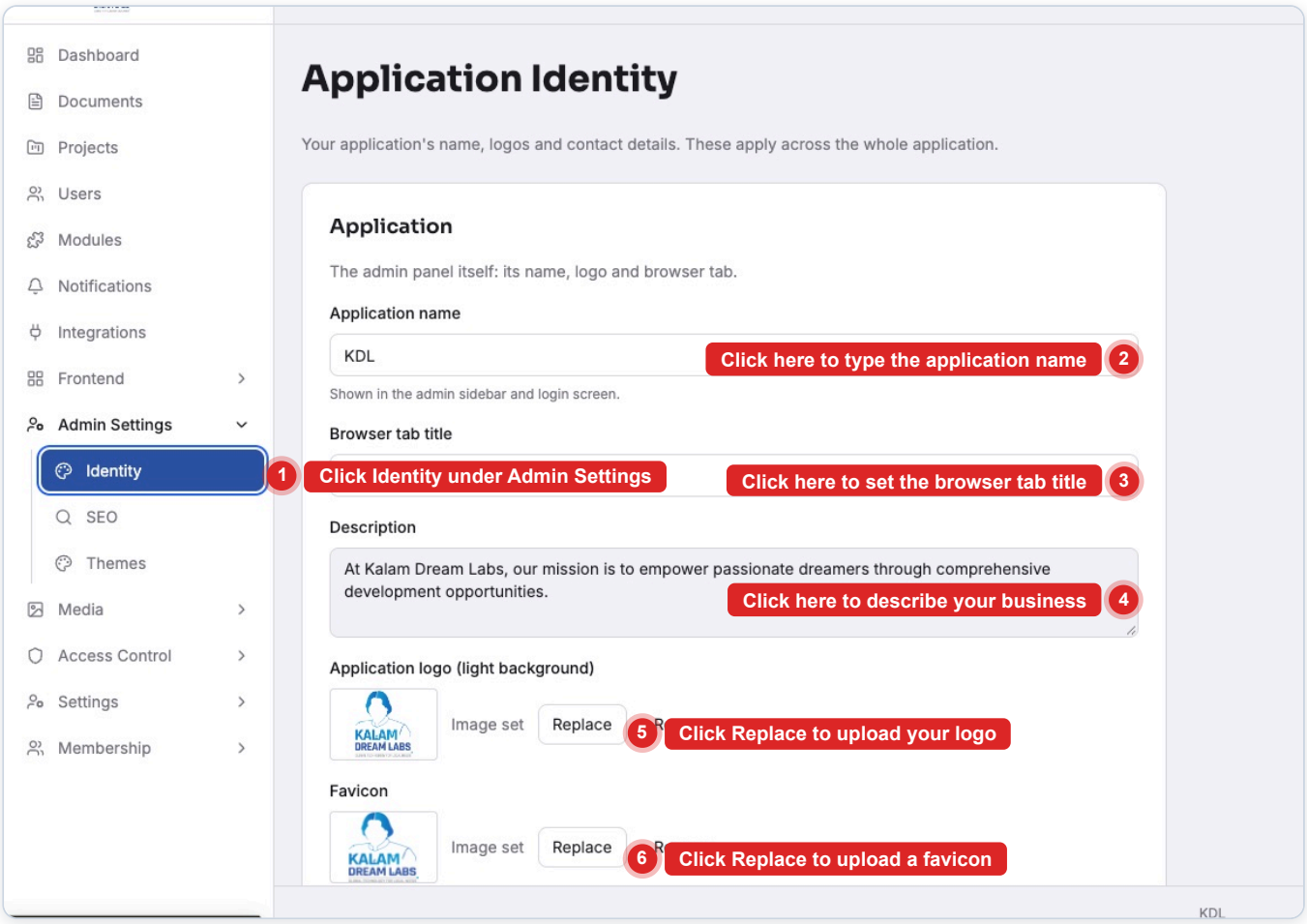


The sign-in screen

> Forgot the password or locked out? `docker compose exec backend node scripts/reset-admin-password.js --email admin@kdl.com --password 'Admin@123'` (at least 8 characters), then sign in with it. 429 or "Account locked" while testing: wait a minute or `docker compose restart backend`.

Step 2. Open Application Identity

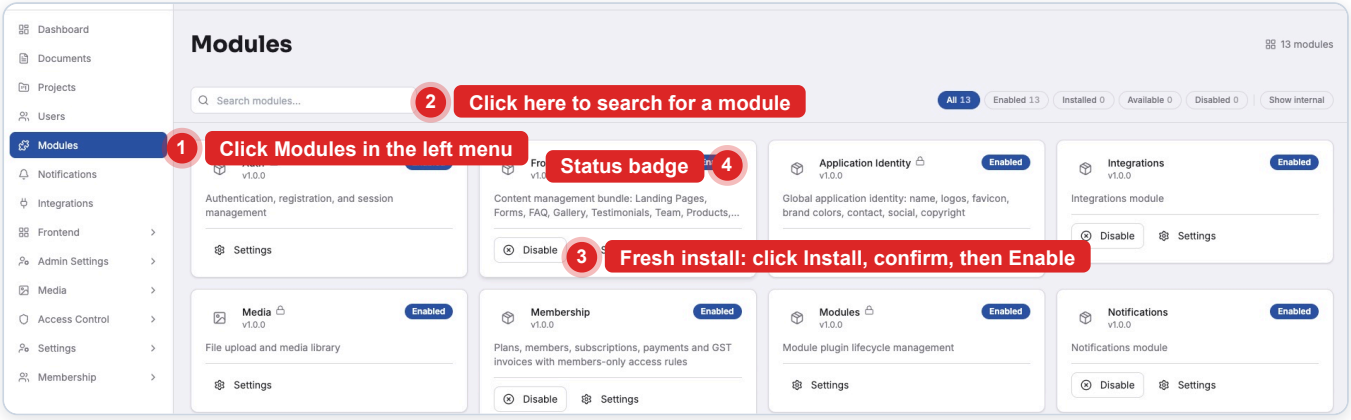
After you sign in, open **Admin Settings > Identity** in the left menu. This is where the application name, logo and favicon are set.



Admin Settings > Identity

Step 3. Open Modules, install and enable Frontend

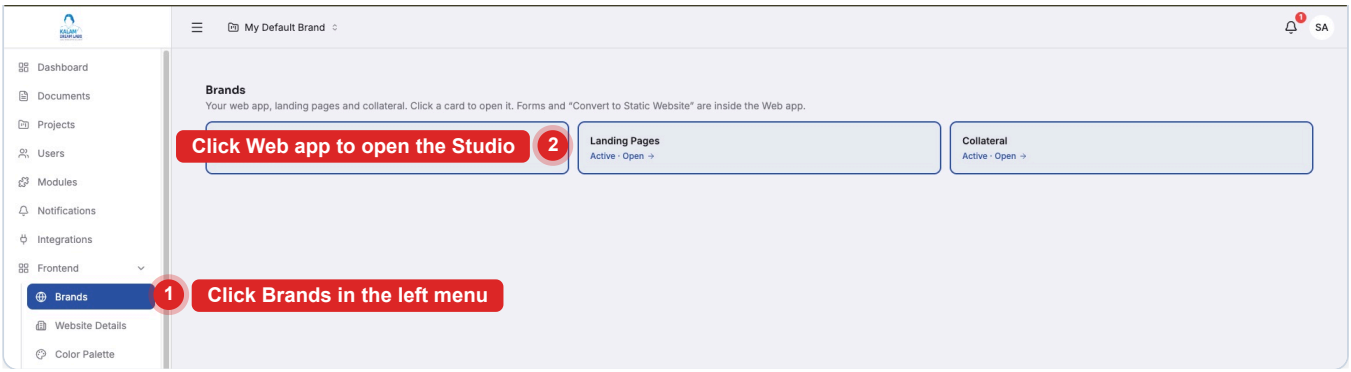
Click **Modules** in the left menu. Find the **Frontend** card (use the search box if you need to). On a fresh install the card shows **Install**: click it and confirm, then click **Enable** and confirm. The badge changes to **Enabled**.



Modules: the Frontend card

Step 4. Open the Studio

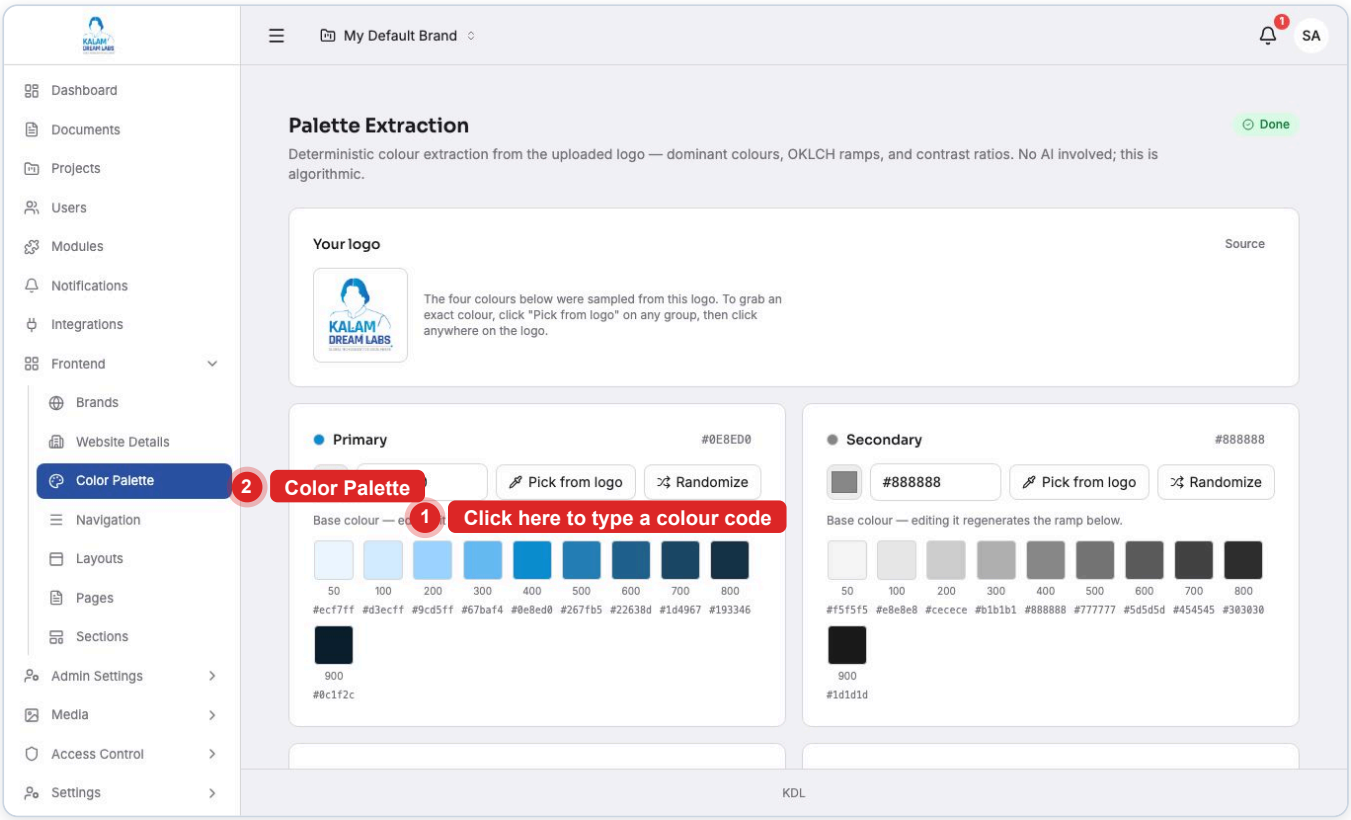
Click **Frontend > Brands** in the left menu, then click the **Web app** card. This opens the Studio for your website. The first time, click **Start Studio run**. Tabs along the top: Overview, Color Palette and Website.



Brands: open the Web app

Step 5. Color Palette

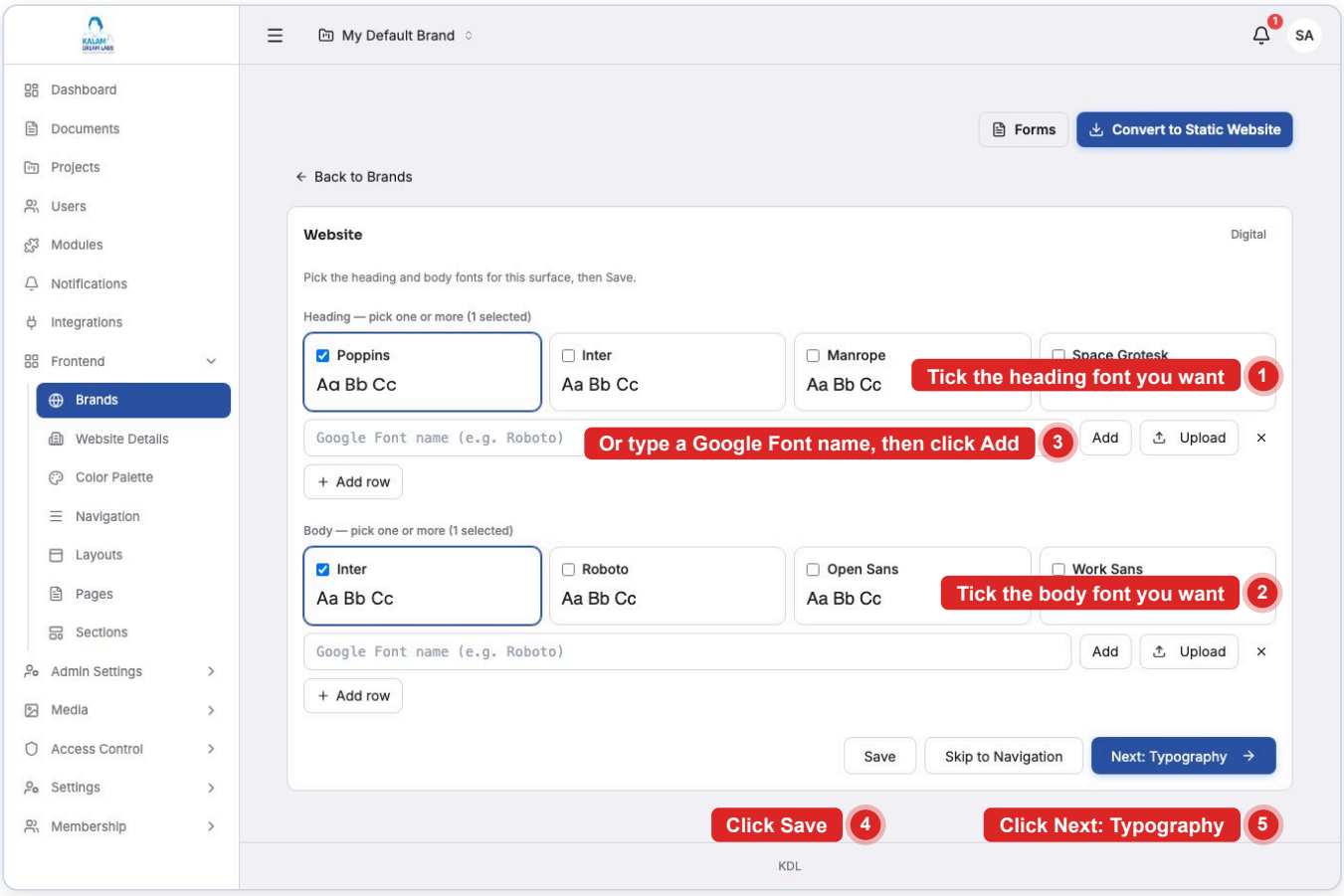
Four brand colours are taken from your logo: Primary, Secondary, Tertiary and Quaternary. Keep them, or click a colour box and type a new code, click **Pick from logo** or **Randomize**. Then click **Submit palette**. The colours become the website's design tokens.



Studio: Color Palette

Step 6. Typography: choose the fonts

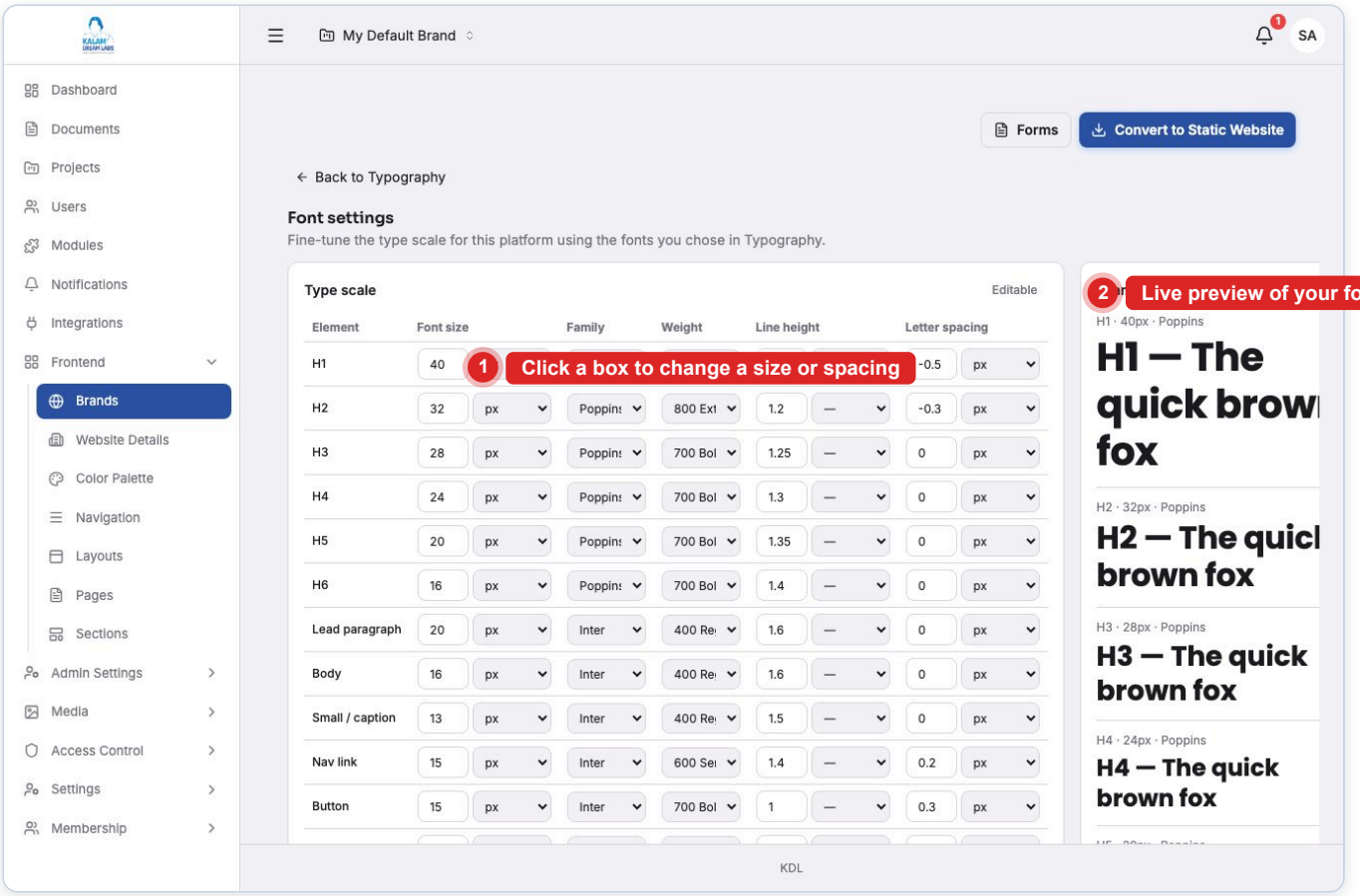
The Website stage opens on **Typography**. Under **Heading** tick the font for titles, and under **Body** tick the font for normal text. To use another font, type its Google Font name (for example Roboto) and click **Add**, or click **Upload** to add your own font file. Click **Save**, then click **Next: Typography** to continue.



Website stage: Typography

Step 7. Font settings

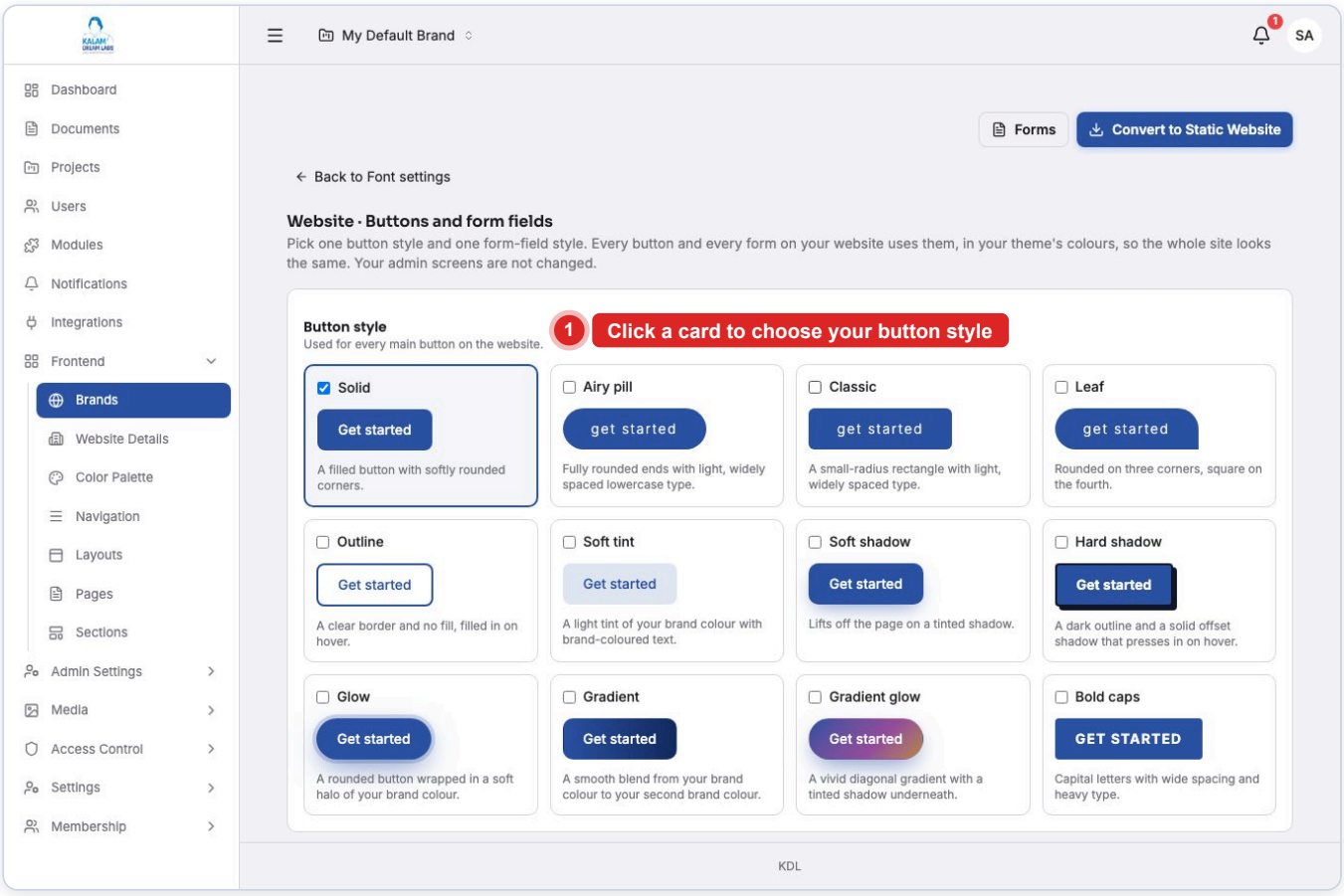
Fine-tune the type scale: for each element (H1 to H6, Lead paragraph, Body, Small, Nav link, Button) change the font size, family, weight, line height and letter spacing. The **Examples** panel on the right shows the result live. The defaults are a good start. Scroll down and click **Next: Buttons and form fields**.



Website stage: Font settings

Step 8. Buttons and form fields

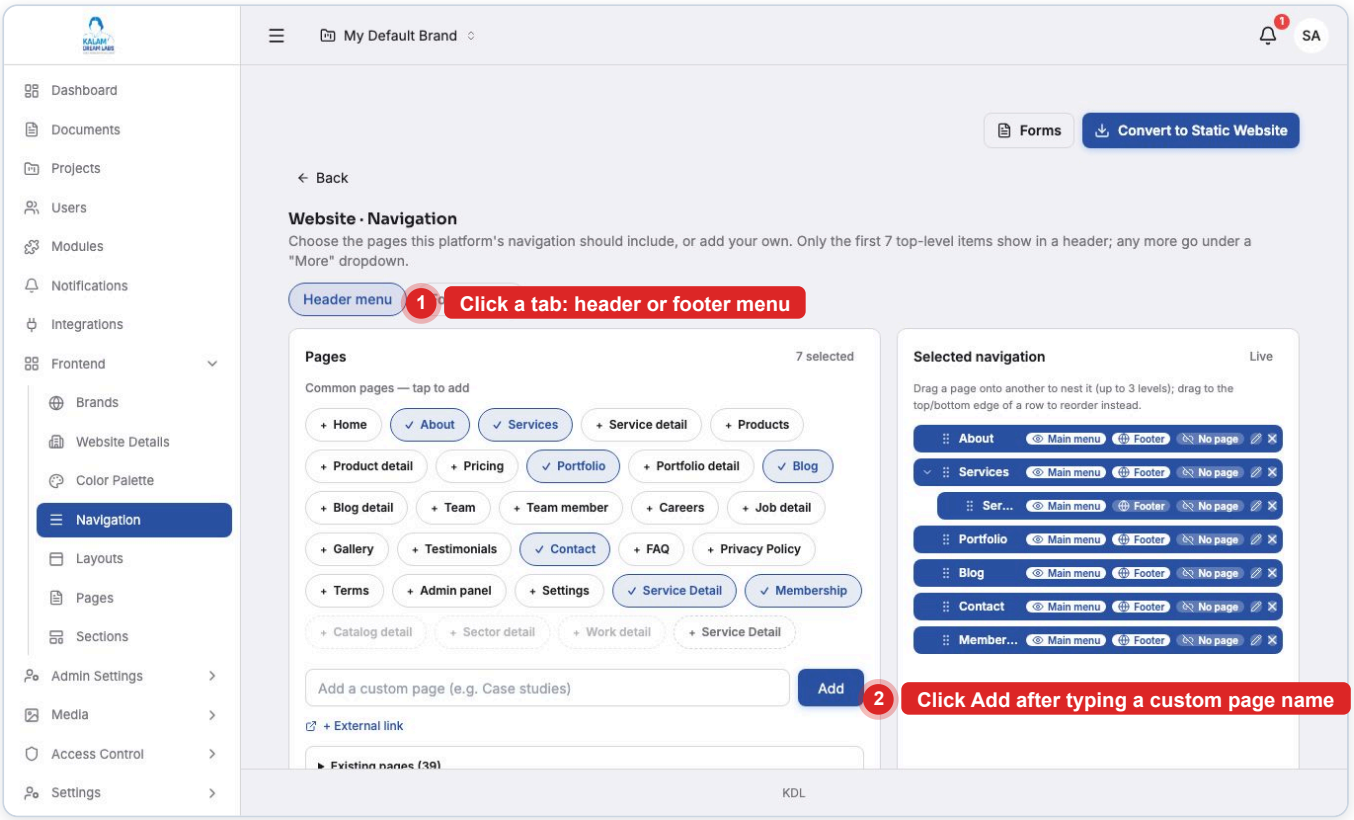
Click one card under **Button style** (Solid, Airy pill, Classic, Leaf, Outline, Soft tint and more), then scroll down and click one card under **Form field style**. Every button and every form on your website uses them, in your theme's colours. The admin screens are not changed. Click **Next** to continue to Navigation.



Website stage: Button style

Step 9. Choose the menu pages

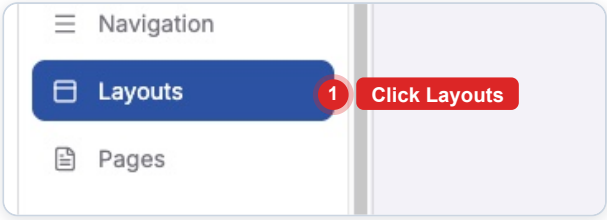
Open **Frontend > Navigation**. Click the page names you want in the menu (About, Services, Portfolio, Blog, Contact and so on), or type a custom page and click **Add**. Use the **Header menu** and **Footer menu** tabs. One page is created for every menu item, plus Home.



Frontend > Navigation

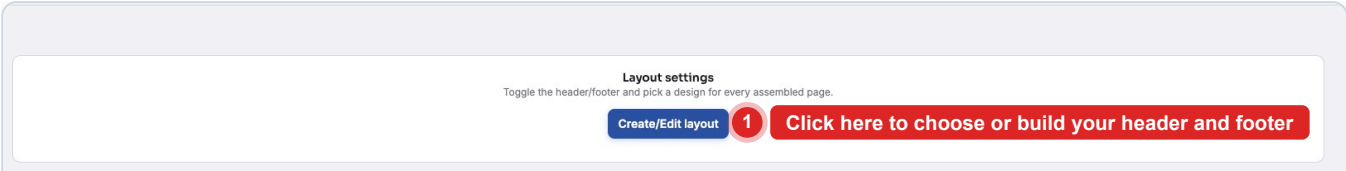
Step 10. Layouts: header and footer

Click **Layouts** in the left menu (under **Frontend**). The page shows **Layout settings**: the header and footer used on every page of your website.



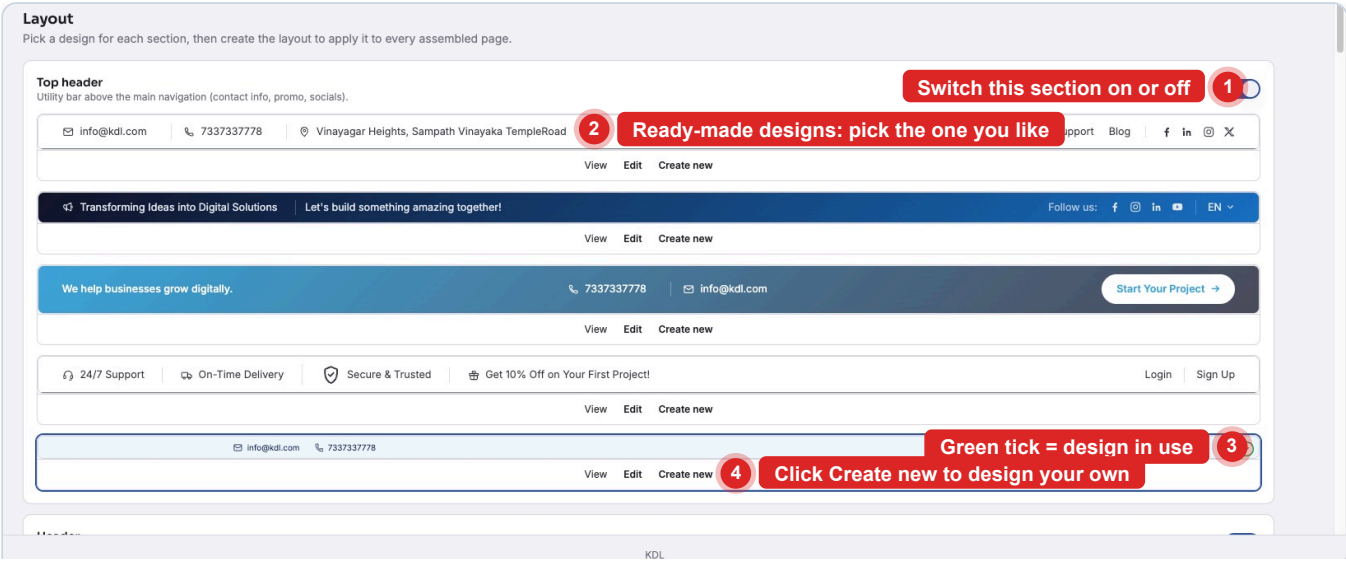
Frontend > Layouts

KDL OS already has ready-made headers and footers. You can use them as they are. If you want a fully custom one, click **Create/Edit layout**.



Layout settings

The **Layout** page lists each section (Top header, Header, Footer and more) with several designs. Use the switch on the right to turn a section on or off, and pick a design: the one with the green tick is in use. For each design you can click **View** to preview it, **Edit** to change it, or **Create new** to build your own from scratch. Then create the layout to apply it to every page. The header and footer of **Home** are shared by every public page.

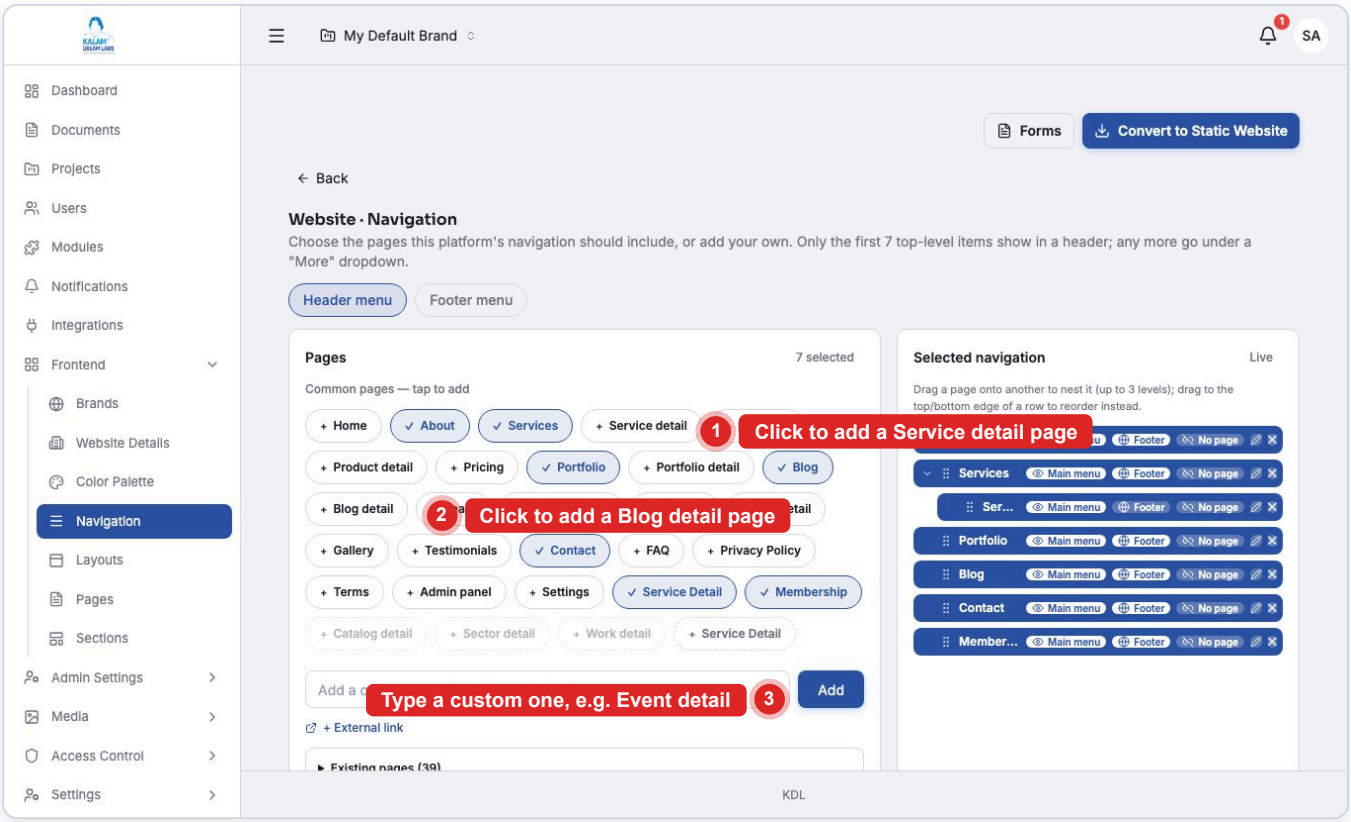


Layout: pick a design for each section

Step 11. Detail pages: one layout for every detail page

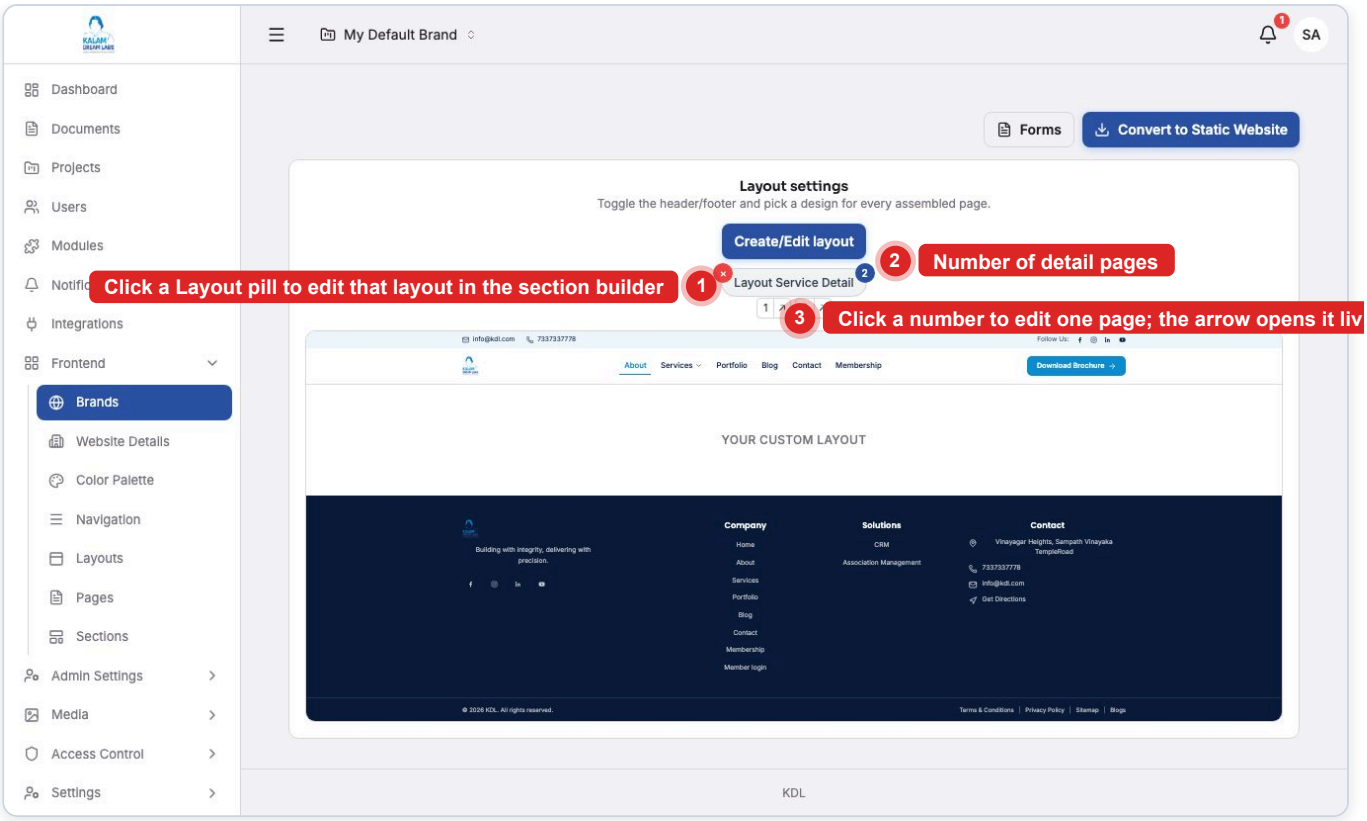
A detail page shows one item: one service, one blog post, one event, one sector. You do not build each by hand. Every item of a type shares one layout, and a page is created for each item.

A. Add the detail page types. Open **Frontend > Navigation**. Click **Service detail**, **Blog detail**, **Portfolio detail**, **Team member** or **Job detail** to add them. For another type, type a name such as **Event detail** and click **Add**. Sector, Catalog and Work detail pages appear once you add entries in those content modules.



Navigation: add the detail pages

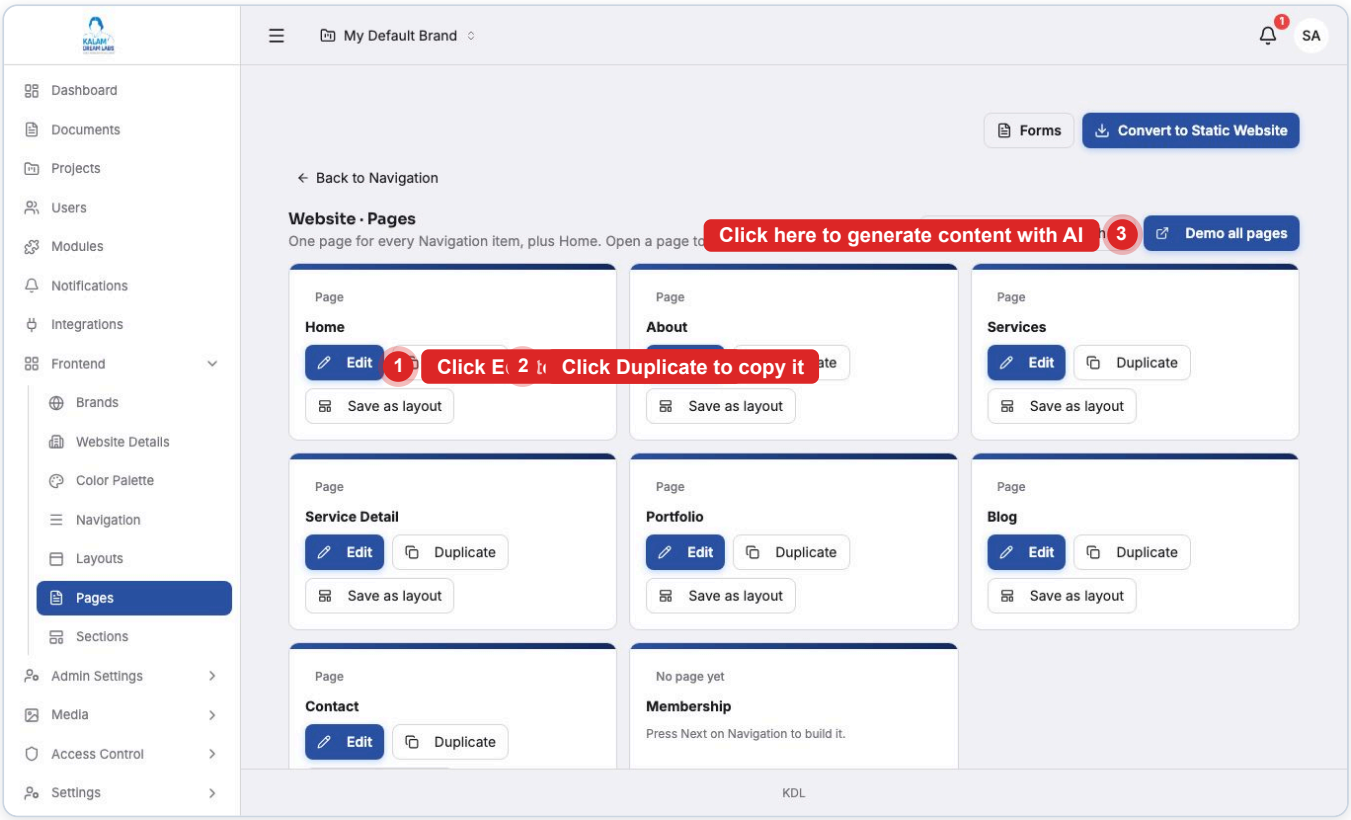
B. Edit the layout. Go back to **Layout settings** (Frontend > Brands > Web app). A pill called **Layout Service Detail** (or Layout Blog Detail, Layout Event Detail and so on) now appears for each type. Click the pill to open the section builder for that layout: change it once and every page of that type changes. The number on the pill is how many detail pages exist. Click a small number under the pill to edit one page's own content (title, text, images); the arrow opens that page live.



Layout settings: the detail page layouts

Step 12. Edit and publish the pages

Open **Frontend > Pages**. Click **Edit** on a page to change its text, images and links in the section builder, then **Save** and **Publish**. Publish stops real problems (an empty page, a missing title, a broken link) and only suggests the rest. Click **Duplicate** to copy a page. **Frontend > Sections** holds reusable sections.

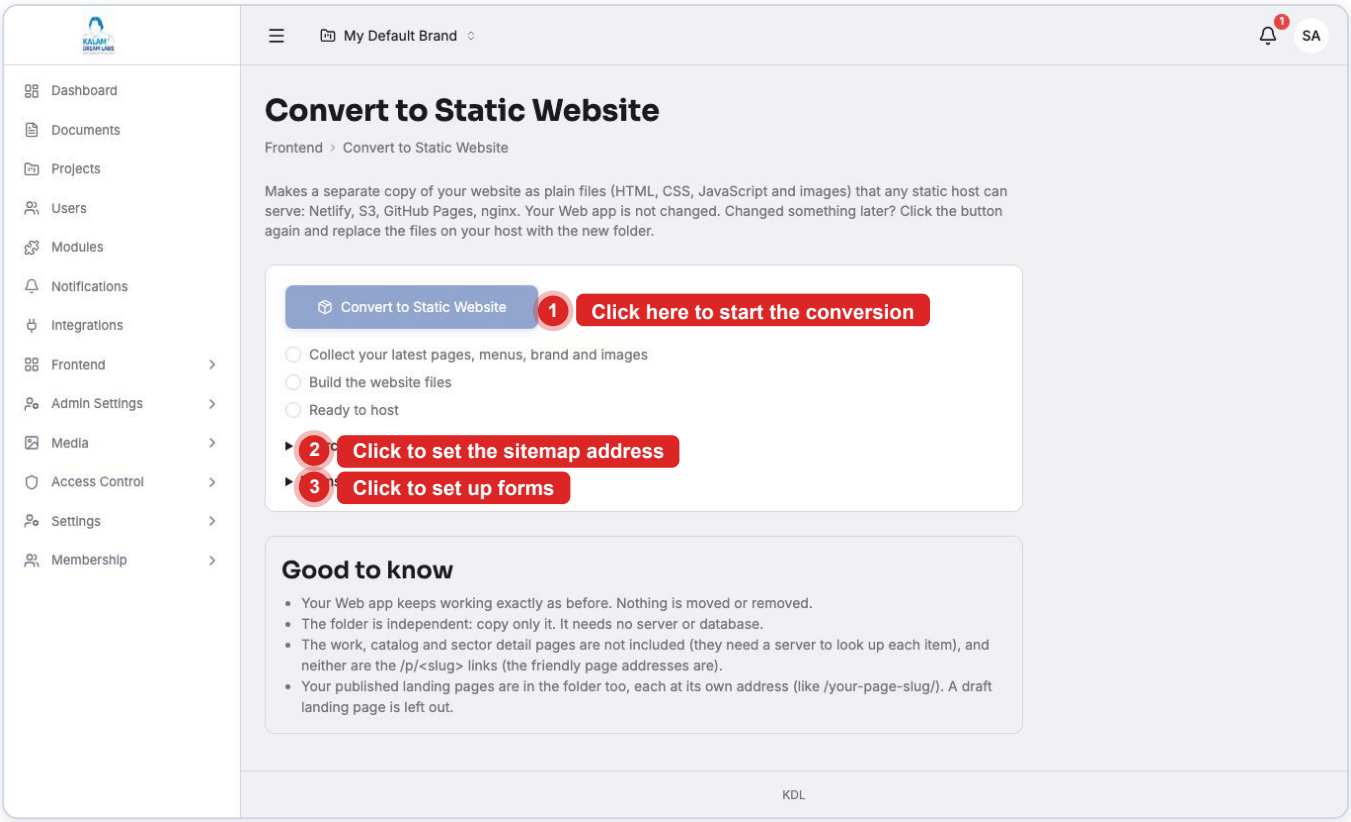


Frontend > Pages

Step 13. Convert to a static website

Static files (HTML, CSS and images) can be hosted anywhere with no server. Publish your pages first, then click **Convert to Static Website** (the button at the top of the Studio, or http://localhost:3001/admin/static-website).

Optional: type your **Website address** (for example https://www.example.com) to add a sitemap. Type your **Web app address** (https only) if forms must keep working; if you leave it empty, forms show your contact email and phone. Click **Convert to Static Website** and wait a few minutes until the card says it is ready.



Frontend > Convert to Static Website

Step 14. Download the files and host them on GitHub

Click **Download as .zip** on the same page and unzip it. The files inside, with `index.html` at the top, are your finished website.

1. On GitHub create a new empty repository, for example `my-website`.
2. Put the files in a new folder, open a terminal in it, and run (use your own username and repository name):

```
TERMINAL
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Website"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/my-website.git
git push -u origin main
```

3. On GitHub open **Settings > Pages**, choose **Deploy from a branch**, pick **main** and the **/ (root)** folder, then **Save**.
4. After a minute your website is live at `https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/my-website/`.

Notes: Changing things later

This is not a step. Use it when something changes.

- **Text, images, links:** Frontend > Pages, Edit, Save, Publish. No re-run is needed.
- **Menus:** Frontend > Navigation.
- **Header, top bar or footer:** Studio > Layouts > Create/Edit layout.
- **Colours or fonts:** Studio > Color Palette, Submit palette.
- After any change: publish, then click **Convert to Static Website** again, replace the files in your GitHub folder, then `git add .`, `git commit -m "Update"` and `git push`. The static copy never updates itself.